

Global Travel and Expense Policy

Comprehensive Policy Manual for Employees and Management

1. Introduction

This Global Travel and Expense Policy (“the Policy”) provides a standardized framework for managing business travel and related expenses within [IT Organization Name]. The primary objective is to ensure all travel and associated expenditures are necessary, reasonable, and appropriately documented, supporting organizational goals while maintaining fiscal responsibility and compliance with applicable laws and regulations.

This Policy establishes clear guidelines for employees, managers, and other stakeholders regarding planning, booking, and reimbursement of business travel and related expenses. It aims to facilitate efficient business operations, promote cost-effective travel practices, and safeguard the organization’s financial assets.

2. Applicability and Eligibility

This Policy applies globally to all employees, contractors, consultants, and authorized representatives of [IT Organization Name] who incur travel or business-related expenses on behalf of the organization. It covers both domestic and international travel, regardless of funding source or business unit.

- **Employees:** All full-time, part-time, and temporary employees.
- **Contractors and Consultants:** Individuals engaged under contract to perform services for the organization, as specified in their engagement agreements.
- **Authorized Representatives:** Any person formally approved to travel or incur expenses on behalf of the organization.

All covered individuals are expected to comply fully with this Policy as a condition of reimbursement and continued engagement.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

- **Employees:** Plan travel in alignment with business needs; obtain pre-approval; book via approved channels; retain and submit receipts; adhere to Policy guidelines.
- **Managers:** Review and approve travel requests; ensure appropriateness and necessity; monitor compliance; address exceptions.

- Finance Department: Review expense submissions; process reimbursements; ensure Policy adherence; maintain records for audit.
- Travel Coordinator: Assist with bookings; provide guidance on Policy; maintain relationships with approved vendors.

4. Pre-Travel Requirements

4.1 Approval Process

All business travel must be pre-approved by the employee's direct manager and, where necessary, by department heads or finance. Travelers must submit a Travel Request Form outlining the purpose, destination, estimated costs, and itinerary.

4.2 Documentation

Travel requests must include supporting documentation (e.g., meeting invitations, agendas, conference details). Approval must be documented in writing before any bookings are made.

5. Booking Procedures

5.1 Approved Vendors and Channels

All travel arrangements must be made through the organization's designated travel management platform or approved travel agencies. Direct bookings with airlines, hotels, or car rental agencies are not permitted unless expressly authorized.

5.2 Class of Service

- Air Travel: Economy class is standard for all employees. Exceptions (e.g., business class for flights over 8 hours) require pre-approval from senior management.
- Rail Travel: Standard or equivalent class; first class requires justification and approval.
- Car Rental: Compact or mid-size vehicles unless larger vehicles are justified by business needs.
- Hotel Accommodation: Standard room rates at approved hotels, subject to cost ceilings set by region.

5.3 Changes and Cancellations

Any changes or cancellations must be reported immediately to the travel coordinator. Costs incurred due to changes without valid business reasons may not be reimbursed.

6. Allowable Expenses

The following expenses are reimbursable when incurred for legitimate business purposes and supported by itemized receipts:

- Transportation: Airfare, train tickets, taxi/rideshare, car rentals, mileage for personal vehicles (at approved rates), tolls, and parking fees.
- Lodging: Hotel accommodations at standard rates, including taxes and mandatory service charges.
- Meals: Reasonable meal costs, including tips, within daily per diem limits set by the organization or local regulatory guidelines.
- Incidentals: Internet access for business use, business phone calls, reasonable laundry for trips exceeding five days.
- Business-Related Costs: Conference registration, business materials, shipping of business documents, and visa fees when required for travel.

All expenses must be reasonable, necessary, and directly related to business activities.

7. Non-Allowable Expenses

Expenses not directly related to business activities or deemed excessive or personal in nature will not be reimbursed. Examples include, but are not limited to:

- Personal entertainment (movies, in-room games, leisure activities)
- Alcoholic beverages (unless part of an approved business event)
- Fines, penalties, or traffic violations
- Personal items (toiletries, clothing, souvenirs)
- Travel upgrades (unless pre-approved)
- Family or companion travel costs
- Loss or theft of personal property
- Non-business meals or expenses for non-employees

8. Reimbursement Process

8.1 Submission

Expense reports must be submitted within 14 calendar days of completing travel. Submissions should be made through the organization's expense management system, accompanied by itemized receipts and the approved Travel Request Form.

8.2 Required Documentation

- Completed expense report form
- Itemized receipts for all expenses
- Proof of travel (boarding passes, hotel invoices)
- Pre-approval documentation

8.3 Timelines and Payment

Reimbursements will be processed within 14 business days of submission, provided all documentation is complete and accurate. Payments will be made via direct deposit unless otherwise specified.

8.4 Discrepancies and Corrections

Any discrepancies or missing information will be communicated promptly. Employees are responsible for addressing issues within five business days to avoid delays or denial of reimbursement.

9. International Travel Guidelines

9.1 Visas and Documentation

Employees are responsible for securing necessary travel documents, including visas and work permits, prior to travel. The organization will reimburse required visa fees when supported by receipts.

9.2 Travel Insurance

All international travelers must obtain organization-approved travel insurance covering medical emergencies, evacuation, and trip interruption. Proof of insurance must be submitted with the travel request.

9.3 Currency and Exchange

Expenses must be reported in local currency and converted to U.S. dollars using the exchange rate on the date of transaction. Supporting documentation for exchange rates (e.g., credit card statement or official rate) must be provided.

9.4 Health and Safety Protocols

International travelers must comply with all organizational health and safety guidelines, including pre-travel health checks, required vaccinations, and adherence to local laws and customs. Emergency contact information and local embassy details must be documented before departure.

10. Compliance and Audit

10.1 Policy Adherence

Strict adherence to this Policy is required. Non-compliance may result in delayed reimbursements, denial of expenses, or disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment or contract.

10.2 Audits

The Finance Department will conduct periodic audits of travel and expense reports to ensure compliance. Employees must retain original receipts and supporting documentation for at least 12 months following reimbursement.

11. Exceptions and Escalation

11.1 Requesting Exceptions

Requests for exceptions must be submitted in writing to the employee's manager and the Finance Department prior to incurring the expense. Requests must include a clear justification and will be considered on a case-by-case basis.

11.2 Escalation Procedures

If an exception request is denied, employees may escalate the matter to the Policy Review Committee. The committee's decision is final.

12. Policy Review and Updates

12.1 Review Frequency

This Policy will be reviewed annually, or more frequently as required by changes in business needs, regulatory requirements, or industry best practices.

12.2 Responsibility for Maintenance

The Finance Department is responsible for maintaining and updating this Policy. Employees and managers are encouraged to provide feedback and report issues or ambiguities to the Policy Review Committee.

13. Appendices

13.1 Sample Forms

- Travel Request Form: Required for all pre-travel approval processes.
- Expense Report Form: Required for reimbursement submissions.

13.2 Contact Information

For questions or clarifications regarding this Policy, contact the Finance Department at [finance@\[organization\].com](mailto:finance@[organization].com) or the Travel Coordinator at [travel@\[organization\].com](mailto:travel@[organization].com).

13.3 Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

- Q: What if I lose a receipt?
- A: Submit a lost receipt affidavit; excessive lost receipts may result in denial of reimbursement.
- Q: Can I book travel independently?
- A: Only if prior written approval is obtained from the Travel Coordinator or Finance Department.
- Q: What is the per diem rate for meals?
- A: Refer to the organization's intranet or contact Finance for current rates by location.
- Q: Who can approve exceptions to the Policy?
- A: Only the Policy Review Committee following the escalation process.

This Policy is effective as of 10/09/2025 and supersedes all previous travel and expense policies. All employees and eligible individuals must acknowledge receipt and understanding of this Policy as a condition of reimbursement.